

25 **Upcoming Events**

What is happening in politics, business, culture and entertainment in the coming week? A handy guide to top events across the country over the next seven days. Keep yourself informed of all that is happening around you.

Give Your Opinion

If you feel strongly about an issue and would like to contribute to the debate initiated by INDIA TODAY, you can write directly to us and express your views.

STATESCAN: KERALA



SHANKAR

Landing with a Thud

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) had proclaimed it as an elite space science institute, the first in the country. But even as the foundation is laid for the Rs 270-crore Indian Institute of Space Technology in Thiruvananthapuram, the project has got embroiled in a controversy. The state Government has issued a notice to ISRO claiming unauthorised occupation of "ecologically fragile" land, reports Special Correspondent M.G. Radhakrishnan.

TALK BACK

Should senior players be dropped altogether from the Indian cricket team?

Visit our website and send in your answers.

WEB EXTRA: DHONI THE MAN

The Story of a Champion

Did you know Mahendra Singh Dhoni used to be a ticket checker with the South Eastern Railway? That at the peak of his popularity, he was offered the post of deputy superintendent of police in Jharkhand, but he had refused? The reason—he wanted to remain focused on cricket, writes Correspondent Amitabh Srivastava.

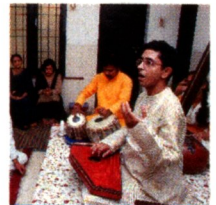


AP PHOTO/AMAN SHARMA

WEB FEATURE: PRIVATE CONCERTS

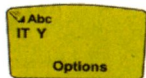
Musical Nights

A growing number of instrumentalists and singers—Hindustani as well as Carnatic—are being invited into the elegantly appointed homes of Chennaiites for private soirees. Mumbai's music lovers have long held baithaks, as have Delhi's old corporate families and Kolkata's bhadralok. Now it's Chennai's turn, writes Sheila Kumar.

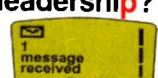
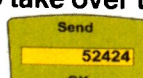
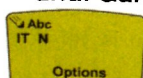


INDIA TODAY INSTANT POLL

#270. Do you think Rahul Gandhi is ready to take over the Congress leadership?



OR



YES

1. Send IT Y to vote YES.

NO

Send IT N to vote NO.

2. Send your vote to the number 52424.

3. You will get confirmation of your vote and the current status of the poll.

* The results of this poll would be published in the next issue

* You can also vote online at www.indiatoday.com

PREVIOUS POLL RESULT

#269. Is Mahendra Singh Dhoni the right choice for captaincy of the Indian odi team?

Answer Breakup	YES	NO
North	68.75.....	31.25
South	85.71.....	14.29
East	81.82.....	18.18
West	86.21.....	13.79

All figures in per cent

YES
80.95

NO
19.05

The India Today Poll conducted through SMS (52424) and on www.indiatoday.com is an instant opinion without classification and sampling of age, income, background and location. The poll is available to all mobile users in India only. Only one vote per mobile number/computer is counted.